

DSAT Reading & Writing — Quotation Illustrates Claim

20 Original Practice Questions | Easy · Medium · Hard

Q1.

[Easy]

The Lantern Road is a 2018 novel by Hana Yusuf. In the novel, the narrator describes her uncle, Mr. Karim, as someone who expresses affection through practical acts rather than words: _____

Which quotation from *The Lantern Road* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Mr. Karim rarely said "I love you," but every morning he polished his niece's shoes until they shone and left them by the door before she woke.'
 - B) 'Mr. Karim was known throughout the neighborhood for his remarkable cooking skills and his prize-winning rose garden.'
 - C) 'Mr. Karim told his niece every evening that she was the most important person in his life.'
 - D) 'Mr. Karim often traveled abroad for work, leaving the household to manage itself for weeks at a time.'
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Q2.

[Easy]

Below the Ridgeline is a 2020 novel by Samuel Adeyemi. The narrator portrays the town of Millhaven as a place where residents resist change: _____

Which quotation from *Below the Ridgeline* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Millhaven was a growing community that eagerly adopted every new technology available.'
 - B) 'Millhaven's annual festival attracted visitors from three neighboring states and generated significant tourism revenue.'
 - C) 'When the county proposed paving the old dirt road, the town council voted it down, arguing that the road had served them fine for a hundred years and would serve them fine for a hundred more.'
 - D) 'The mayor of Millhaven frequently traveled to the state capital to lobby for modern infrastructure funding.'
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Q3.

[Easy]

Copper and Sage is a 2017 novel by Eloise Marchetti. The narrator describes her grandmother as someone who treated cooking as a form of storytelling: _____

Which quotation from *Copper and Sage* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Grandmother followed recipes with scientific precision, measuring each ingredient to the gram.'
 - B) 'Grandmother rarely cooked, preferring instead to eat at the small restaurant on the corner.'
 - C) 'Grandmother's kitchen was always immaculate, with every pot hung in its designated place.'
 - D) 'Each dish Grandmother prepared carried a narrative—the lamb stew was her mother's recipe from the old country, the honey cake commemorated the year the bees returned to the orchard, and the bread was kneaded in a rhythm she said matched the heartbeat of the village.'
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Q4.

[Easy]

The Glass Pier is a 2019 novel by Tomás Rivera-Santos. The text presents a contrast between the protagonist, Elena, and her sister, Luz, suggesting that Elena is cautious while Luz is impulsive: _____

Which quotation from *The Glass Pier* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Elena would study a menu for twenty minutes before ordering the same dish she always had; Luz would close her eyes, point, and declare whatever her finger landed on to be destiny.'
 - B) 'Elena and Luz both enjoyed reading novels in the afternoon sun.'
 - C) 'Elena admired her sister's intelligence and often sought her advice on important decisions.'
 - D) 'Luz was known for her careful budgeting and her refusal to make any purchase without researching it first.'
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Q5.

[Easy]

Night Freight is a 2021 novel by Kwame Asare. The narrator describes the old train station as a place that inspires a sense of abandonment: _____

Which quotation from *Night Freight* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'The station had been recently renovated, its platforms gleaming with fresh paint and polished brass.'
 - B) 'Travelers crowded the platform each morning, jostling for position as the express train arrived.'
 - C) 'The station was conveniently located at the center of town, making it a popular meeting point.'
 - D) 'Weeds pushed through the cracked tiles of the platform, and the ticket booth's glass was so thick with dust that the schedule behind it had become unreadable.'
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Q6.

[Easy]

The Mapmaker's Daughter is a 2016 novel by Rina Chatterjee. The text describes the character Devika as possessing an exceptional memory: _____

Which quotation from *The Mapmaker's Daughter* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Devika was well known in her office for her creative problem-solving and her ability to motivate colleagues.'
 - B) 'Devika could recite the name of every student who had sat beside her in school, the color of their notebooks, and the order in which the teacher had called roll on the first day of every term.'
 - C) 'Devika frequently forgot where she had parked her car and relied on a phone app to locate it.'
 - D) 'Devika preferred reading fiction to nonfiction, claiming that novels taught her more about human nature than any textbook.'
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Q7.

[Medium]

Watershed is a 2022 novel by Ingrid Solheim. In the novel, the narrator suggests that the character Henrik uses humor as a shield to avoid discussing his emotions: _____

Which quotation from *Watershed* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Henrik laughed freely at his friends' jokes but rarely made any of his own.'
 - B) 'Henrik was known for his serious demeanor and his reluctance to engage in lighthearted conversation.'
 - C) 'Whenever someone asked Henrik how he was really feeling, he would grin and answer with a punchline—"Fantastic, like a house on fire," he once said, the week his divorce was finalized.'
 - D) 'Henrik openly shared his struggles with his closest friends, finding comfort in their sympathy.'
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Q8.

[Medium]

Salt and Iron is a 2019 novel by Chibuzo Eze. The narrator characterizes the village elder, Nneka, as someone whose authority derives not from her title but from the community's trust in her judgment: _____

Which quotation from *Salt and Iron* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Nneka held the highest official rank in the village council and enforced her decisions with strict penalties.'
 - B) 'The villagers obeyed Nneka not because she could compel them—she had no power to punish—but because her counsel had never steered them wrong, and they had come to regard her word as more reliable than any written law.'
 - C) 'Nneka was appointed by the regional governor and answered only to the central administration.'
 - D) 'Nneka rarely attended village meetings, preferring to send her decisions in written form.'
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Q9.

[Medium]

The Understory is a 2021 novel by Nikolai Avenov. The narrator suggests that the protagonist, Dr. Linden, views scientific fieldwork as an almost spiritual practice: _____

Which quotation from *The Understory* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'For Dr. Linden, kneeling in the moss to count seedlings was not labor but a kind of prayer—each data point an offering to a truth larger than herself.'
 - B) 'Dr. Linden kept meticulous field notebooks, recording each specimen's location with GPS coordinates and timestamps.'
 - C) 'Dr. Linden frequently published her research in top-tier scientific journals and presented at international conferences.'
 - D) 'Dr. Linden complained that fieldwork was physically exhausting and looked forward to returning to her laboratory.'
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Q10.

[Medium]

The Borrowed Year is a 2020 novel by Fatima Al-Rashid. The text presents the narrator's father as someone who believed that education was the only reliable form of wealth: _____

Which quotation from *The Borrowed Year* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'My father invested most of his savings in real estate, believing that property was the safest store of value.'
 - B) '"They can take your house and your land," my father would say, tapping his temple, "but they cannot repossess what is in here."'
 - C) 'My father was a quiet man who rarely offered advice on any subject.'
 - D) 'My father valued practical trades over academic study, urging his children to learn carpentry and plumbing.'
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Q11.

[Medium]

Harbour Lights is a 2018 novel by Delia Caron. The narrator describes the seaside town of Brixton Cove as a place whose economy depends entirely on the unpredictable rhythms of the fishing season: _____

Which quotation from *Harbour Lights* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Brixton Cove had diversified its economy with tourism, a small tech startup, and a thriving arts scene.'
 - B) 'Brixton Cove was located conveniently between two major cities, making it a popular commuter town.'
 - C) 'In good years, when the catch was abundant, the town hummed with prosperity—new boats were ordered, debts were paid, and the pub stayed open past midnight. In lean years, the same town went quiet, its docks empty, its storefronts dark.'
 - D) 'The residents of Brixton Cove had petitioned the government to build a factory that would provide year-round employment.'
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Q12.

[Medium]

Northern Meridian is a 2017 novel by Ingrid Solheim. The narrator suggests that the lighthouse keeper, Astrid, finds human conversation exhausting in a way that solitude is not: _____

Which quotation from *Northern Meridian* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Astrid hosted dinner parties every weekend, filling the lighthouse with laughter and conversation.'
 - B) 'Astrid's loneliness at the lighthouse eventually drove her to request a transfer to the mainland.'
 - C) 'After an hour with visitors, Astrid felt as though she had run a marathon, her mind aching from the effort of following their words; alone with the sea, she could sit for a full day without fatigue.'
 - D) 'Astrid was known for her warmth and sociability, and colleagues frequently sought her company.'
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Q13.

[Medium]

The Quiet Republic is a 2015 novel by Omar Bello. The text suggests that the character Augusto has come to see silence not as consent but as a survival strategy: _____

Which quotation from *The Quiet Republic* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Augusto spoke freely at every public meeting, earning a reputation as the neighborhood's most vocal critic.'
 - B) "'We do not hold our tongues because we have nothing to say,'" Augusto told his son. "We hold them because the price of speech is one we cannot afford to pay."
 - C) 'Augusto believed that silence was a sign of agreement, and he admired those who practiced it.'
 - D) 'Augusto left the city to find a place where he could speak without consequence.'
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Q14.

[Hard]

The Cartographer's Silence is a 2020 novel by Anwar Haddad. The narrator suggests that the protagonist views his maps of endangered landscapes as acts of defiance against the forces that threaten those landscapes: _____

Which quotation from *The Cartographer's Silence* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Each contour line he traced was a refusal—a declaration that the marsh, the grove, the meadow had existed and that no developer's bulldozer could erase a thing already recorded.'
 - B) 'He drew the maps on commission for the development authority, providing the technical data they needed to proceed with their plans.'
 - C) 'He preferred digital mapping software to hand-drawn maps, finding the precision of satellite imagery more reliable.'
 - D) 'His maps were admired for their artistic beauty but lacked the accuracy required for official land surveys.'
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Q15.

[Hard]

Bridge of Reeds is a 2019 novel by Daniel Okwu. The narrator portrays Elder Nkechi as someone whose wisdom lies not in offering solutions but in asking questions that force others to reconsider their assumptions: _____

Which quotation from *Bridge of Reeds* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Nkechi issued her decision immediately, leaving no room for debate.'
 - B) 'When the young farmers demanded a new irrigation canal, Nkechi did not say yes or no. Instead she asked, "What happened to the last canal we built?" and the room fell silent, for they all knew it had dried up within a decade.'
 - C) 'Nkechi was celebrated for her eloquent speeches, which she delivered at every village gathering.'
 - D) 'Nkechi always deferred to the opinion of the village's youngest members, believing that age brought rigidity rather than wisdom.'
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Q16.

[Hard]

Tidal Ledger is a 2022 poetry collection by Yuki Tanabe. The speaker uses the image of tides to suggest that loss is not a single event but an ongoing process of gradual erosion: _____

Which quotation from *Tidal Ledger* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'It was not the wave that took the shore / but the tide's long habit of return, / each visit carrying a little more / of what I thought was mine to keep.'
 - B) 'The storm came suddenly, sweeping everything away in a single violent hour.'
 - C) 'She walked along the beach at dawn, collecting stones polished smooth by the water.'
 - D) 'The harbor was rebuilt after the hurricane, stronger and more modern than before.'
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Q17.

[Hard]

Season of Dust is a 2019 novel by Lena Okafor. The narrator characterizes Amara's grandmother as someone who communicates disapproval not through words but through deliberate, pointed silence: _____

Which quotation from *Season of Dust* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Grandmother scolded Amara loudly whenever she broke a rule, her voice carrying across the courtyard.'
 - B) 'Grandmother praised Amara warmly for every achievement, no matter how small.'
 - C) 'Grandmother expressed her opinions freely and expected her grandchildren to do the same.'
 - D) 'When Amara announced she was leaving the village, her grandmother said nothing. She simply set down her teacup with exaggerated care, folded her hands, and looked out the window as though Amara had not spoken at all—a silence so deliberate it was louder than any rebuke.'
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Q18.

[Hard]

The Unfinished Garden is a 2022 novel by Rosa Figueroa. The text suggests that the architect, Valentina, believes the value of creative work lies in the process of making it, not in whether it is ever used: _____

Which quotation from *The Unfinished Garden* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'Valentina measured her success by the number of buildings that bore her name, counting each completed project as a trophy.'
 - B) 'Valentina abandoned any project that did not receive funding within six months, believing that uncommissioned work was wasted effort.'
 - C) 'Valentina's firm was known for completing projects ahead of schedule and under budget.'
 - D) "'A drawing that solves a problem is a drawing that matters," Valentina told her apprentice, "even if the building is never built. The thinking is the thing—the rest is just weather."
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Q19.

[Hard]

Borrowed Light is a 2018 essay collection by Saoirse Brennan. The speaker suggests that memory does not preserve the past faithfully but instead reshapes it to reflect what the rememberer needs in the present: _____

Which quotation from *Borrowed Light* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'I remember every detail of that summer with photographic precision—the dates, the conversations, the exact color of the sky.'
 - B) 'I keep a detailed journal so that my memories will remain accurate and unaltered by time.'
 - C) 'The kitchen I remember is not the kitchen that existed. I have rearranged the furniture, softened the light, removed the argument from the table and replaced it with laughter, because that is the kitchen I need to have come from.'
 - D) 'My sister and I recall the same events in exactly the same way, confirming that our memories are reliable.'
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Q20.

[Hard]

The Thread and the Needle is a 2021 novel by Elif Bozkurt. The narrator suggests that the tailor sees his craft as a way of imposing order on the chaos of human life, with each garment representing a small act of control: _____

Which quotation from *The Thread and the Needle* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) 'The tailor used only mass-produced fabrics, finding handmade textiles too unpredictable for his purposes.'
 - B) 'The tailor disliked his profession and dreamed of becoming a musician instead.'
 - C) 'The tailor's shop was the most profitable business on the street, owing to his shrewd pricing strategy.'
 - D) "'People come to me in disarray," the tailor said, pressing a lapel flat with his iron. "Their marriages are failing, their children are ungrateful, their businesses are collapsing. I cannot fix any of that. But I can make a seam that is straight, a hem that is even, a collar that lies flat. And for the hour they wear my coat, the world fits."
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